

Chapter 15

Abhimanyu's Dilemma—The Art of Selling

To be a good investor, we need a robust framework for both the buying and selling of stocks. The first 14 chapters of this tome have been primarily focused on the various facets of making great investments. Making an investment is only half of the battle—the easy part. We also need an equally robust framework for selling. Selling a stock is a more difficult decision than buying one—thus the need for a robust framework and some help from our dear friend Abhimanyu. Abhimanyu is the hero of this chapter. I like to think that one of the reasons he martyred himself was so that we, as modern capitalists, could learn vicariously from his experience and become vastly better investors.

With one hundred thousand stanzas, the *Mahabharata*¹ is perhaps the grandest epic poem ever written. It was penned in Sanskrit in India about 2,000 years ago. While the main subject is a bloody feud between two branches of a North Indian ruling family, the *Mahabharata* is chock-full of deep philosophical lessons. The family conflict culminates in an epic 18-day battle between the Pandavas and Kauravas. The Pandavas are the good guys while the Kauravas aren't entirely an above-board set.

Pronunciations

Abhimanyu	a-bee-man-u
Arjuna	r-june
<i>Chakravyuh</i>	chuck-rah-view
Kauravas	core-ruvs